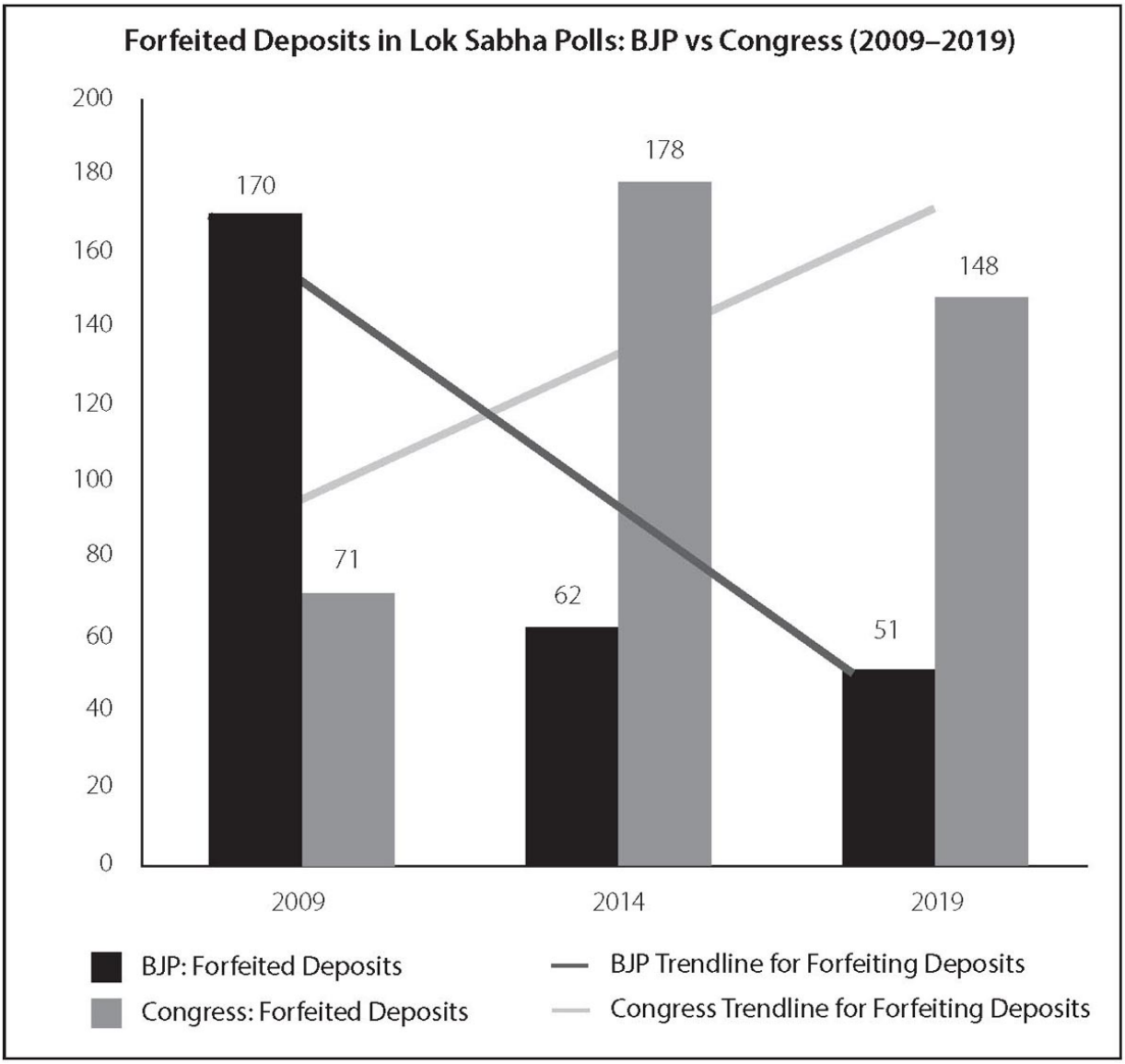


Source: Author's analysis of ECI Statistical Reports: 2009–2019. Note: The BJP contested 433 seats in 2009, 428 in 2014 and 436 in 2019. The Congress contested 440 in 2009, 464 in 2014 and 421 in 2019.

Another instance of the growing power gap between the two parties emerged while I was travelling to Raebareli, Sonia Gandhi's parliamentary constituency, in June 2020. The road to Raebareli ran through a gate of saffron: the imposing Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Dwar. Named after one of the BJP's early founding figures, and sporting the smiling visages of UP Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath and Prime Minister Narendra Modi, it towered over all visitors driving south into Raebareli on National Highway No. 30 from Lucknow, the